

OREGON CITY COURIER

C. W. ROBEY, Editor and Business Manager

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CONSCRIPTION

Democracy is purest fraternity. We Americans are fraternal brothers, having equal say in affairs of state.

To be conscripted by a despot would be humiliating; but there is no despot in these United States.

In past wars in which Americans engaged an odium attached to conscription, and you know why. First came calls for volunteers. Then, when all had volunteered who would, the slackers were conscripted, "drafted" was the word used in the civil war, but the meaning is the same. There was no glory for slackers who were drafted into war.

Now we are to have conscription for this war, yet no odium attaches to it, and, again, you know why.

We are, remember, fraternal brothers, having equal say in governmental affairs.

We are not to be conscripted by a despot. We are to be conscripted by ourselves. It is our own doing. We are a sovereign people, and it is our sovereign will that we employ conscription for this war.

Furthermore, we are not to employ conscription as a LAST resort, but as a FIRST resort. We, the freemen, do not propose to use conscription to drag unwilling slackers to war.

That thought makes, and ought to make, a big difference in the American mind.

We are to have selective conscription. And yet again you know why.

Some of us might fight. Some of us might nurse. Some of us must work in munition plants. Some of us must produce food.

Selective conscription will put fighters in the trenches, nurses in the hospitals, skilled workers in the factories, and farmers on the soil. That's efficiency. Thus we will win the war.

Those of us who want to "do our bit" will not object to conscription. And we will have the satisfying knowledge that, whether willingly or otherwise, the slackers, too, are doing their share.

WANTED—A MOSES

The Courier is in favor of the \$6,000,000 bond issue for good roads. It believes in the integrity of the men who will have the handling of the fund; it believes the burden will fall where it properly belongs, and it believes that delay in the construction of good roads is a woeful economic waste. But it realizes that there is an honest difference of opinion regarding the issue, and regrets that so much feeling has been aroused over that difference. It is hard to believe that Oregon is more parsimonious in the matter of raising funds for good roads than Washington and California, yet the evidence would so indicate. Possibly our sister states are greater spendthrifts, and weigh costs more carefully, but they certainly have better roads, more tourists and cheaper transportation to markets than careful old Oregon. Isn't it possible to get at the truth of so important a matter as this? Or must we drag along through the mud until our roads become a byword and a reproach—the while we are praying for more light? Oh, for a Moses to lead us out of this wilderness of doubt!

ABAS THE FOOD SPECULATOR

The Voter, Portland's "weekly magazine of citizenship," flies to the defense of the merchants who are storing eggs for fall and winter sale, and makes out a good case for them. But the storage of eggs isn't what is bothering the consumer. It's the speculation in chicken feed that is forcing the rancher to sell off his laying hens, thus bringing about a condition that will boost the price of eggs to \$1.00 a dozen within a few months. The market is full of fine red-combed laying hens now because the farmer cannot afford to buy wheat. Our chickens are being slaughtered to make a wheat speculator's holiday.

And this is but a minor phase of the situation. The loaf of bread is shrinking at a rate that will soon make half a loaf about the equivalent of no bread at all. Patience may some day cease to be a virtue even in easy-going, extravagant America, and when that day comes, food speculators had better flee to the trenches, where they will at least have a chance to save their unblushing hides.

THUMBS DOWN FOR BOOZE

The action of the United States senate in passing the measure to prohibit the use of grains in the manufacture of alcoholic drinks will meet with the hearty commendation of all thinking people. That the vote against the measure was so heavy merely emphasizes the necessity of such legislative action, for it is an indication of the vise-like grip John Barleycorn has on this country. It would be too much to intimate that all who opposed the measure are drinking men unwilling to deny themselves even at a time when the nation faces a crisis, but whatever the motives behind the negative vote, it must give way to sacrificial patriotism.

The "personal freedom" idea dies hard, but die it must when the brain, brawn and very soul of a nation is at stake. So let us away with John Barleycorn until the freedom of the seas is established and then, if the people are still blind to their own interests and further discussion be necessary, the struggle for a cleaner national life may be fought to a finish on the forums of the country.

It has been said that the American cocktail follows the flag. If 32 U. S. senators could have their way, the flag would have to follow the cocktail.

Collier's describes a country road as "a strip of unowned land over which anyone is free to walk, ride or drive—if he can!" We know a little stretch of road in Oregon that fits the description.

In view of the great back-to-the-soil movement now on, we are surprised not to find Markham's "Man With the Hoe" in every county contemporary that comes to our desk. Guess they balk at that "brother to the ox" sentiment.

The movement fostered by the Oregon State Poultry Breeder's association to furnish free war chicks to boys and girls would work out fine if only some other association would furnish grain to feed them. It is almost a crime to bring baby chicks into a grainless world.

No wonder Spring lingers in the lap of Winter "until it excites considerable talk," as Bill Nye once said. She has probably been waiting for the Bock beer signs to appear, as a signal to break away from Winter—evidently not knowing that "there ain't no such animal" in Oregon any more.

Did you wear a carnation on "Mother's Day" as an outward manifestation of the love you bear her, or did you ignore the pretty custom and take it for granted that she knows you love her? Oh Boy! When will you learn that much of mother's unhappiness in this world is caused by your "taking things for granted."

CORRESPONDENCE

(Continued from page 2)

Miss Tillie and Albert Martin attended the serenade given at the home of Mr. Bonney in honor of the "newly-weds," Mr. and Mrs. Ona Klinger.

Mrs. Schmidt and niece, Mrs. Klumpp of Portland, visited Mrs. C. C. Kandle Friday.

Crystal Rath entertained Mae McNaught, Opal Mason, Thelma and Mildred Simms Sunday.

Mr. Acree and son, Everett, left last Thursday for Madras. Joe Wal-



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OREGON CITY, OREGON

lace and Archie Rath are helping to move Frank Bittner's spooling mill to Bull Run, where Frank has a new mill site.

M. E. Kandle and wife went to Colton on business Monday.

Mrs. McNaught, Mrs. C. C. Kandle and Mrs. Lena Wallace called on Mrs. Anna Rath Sunday.

Mrs. Meeker and son, Earl, visited at the home of her daughter, Mrs. Rambo, Sunday.

Joe Smith was in Oregon City Thursday.

JENNINGS LODGE

Friday afternoon being the regular Parent-Teachers' meeting time, a number of patrons assembled at the school house to hear Judge Dimick, who spoke on Industrial club work, his talk proving very interesting and helpful. The pupils of Mrs. Altman's room favored the audience with a song. The annual election of officers took place, in which an entirely new staff was elected. Those who will concentrate their efforts for the Parent-Teachers' association work for the coming year are: Mrs. Edith Truscott, president; Miss Ella Kennedy, vice-president; Miss Nellie Sanders, secretary; Miss Della Roberts, treasurer. At the close a ball game between the pupils of the Concord and Jennings Lodge schools proved an interesting part of the afternoon. The score was 5 to 3 in favor of the home school. Ice cream was on sale and the pupils enjoyed a picnic luncheon at the noon hour.

It was with the sincerest regret that the association learned that the primary teacher, Miss Snashall, had chosen a new field of labor for the fall term. The patrons will feel the loss of Miss Snashall, for she has proven a very successful teacher, and the parents have greatly appreciated her efforts with the little folks. Resolutions of regret were passed by the association on the departing of Miss Snashall. The June meeting will be in the form of installment of the new officers, and the new committees will be appointed, which will make plans during the summer to take up the Parent-Teacher work in September with renewed activity.

Mr. and Mrs. S. H. Bechtel entertained with a six o'clock dinner on Saturday evening in honor of Arthur Smith, Jr.'s fifth birthday. The guests were Miss Vera Glass and the members of the A. B. Smith family. Later in the evening, by invitation of Mrs. Smith and Mrs. Bechtel, thirty young people arrived at the Bechtel home and pleasantly surprised Miss Glass, whose eighteenth birthday fell also on this date. Music contests and games and the serving of delicious refreshments rounded out a happy affair. Miss Fern Hart won the prize in the contest. Congratulations

and pretty gifts were showered upon Miss Glass by the Misses Annie Russell, Mary and Wilma Bruechert, LeClaire Ostrom, Margaret Tucker, Ethel and Fern Hart, Ouida Deter, Bessie Roberts, Lena Costley, Lois Thayer, Cathrine Langdon; Arthur Roberts, Carey Deter, Lorraine Ostrom, DeWitt Campbell, Frank Turner, Theodore Yung, Glen Russell and Arthur Roberts.

Mr. and Mrs. Arthur Smith motored to Canby on Sunday to spend the day with relatives.

Mr. Ward, who has spent the past two years at this place, departed on Sunday evening for Seattle.

Mrs. De Forrest returned from Kansas on Saturday evening. Her mission to the middle west was to be with her son, De Forrest Pomeroy, who passed away in Minneapolis some three weeks ago. The remains were interred near the old family home in Kansas.

John Pomeroy of Kamai, Idaho, and Mr. and Mrs. Rayan and Mrs. Hildebrand of Portland motored to visit the E. A. Sanders family, Mrs. Sanders being a sister of Mr. Pomeroy and Mrs. Ryan.

Mr. and Mrs. Lansdowne, who spent their honeymoon during the summer of 1912 on the banks of the Willamette, were dinner guests of H. H. Emmons and wife on Sunday, and also called on other friends before returning to Portland.

Mr. and Mrs. Turner are rejoicing over the arrival of their first son, who came into their home on Wednesday of last week.

Mr. Brownrigg's home on the east county road was robbed of potatoes and clothing on Tuesday evening of last week.

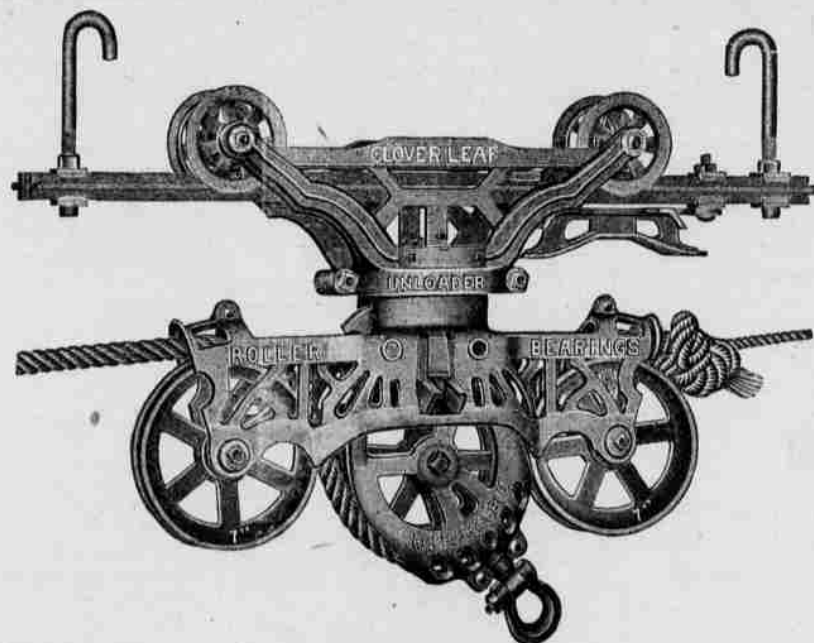
Mrs. Lehman of Sycamore spent Monday night with her mother, Mrs. Kretschmer. On Saturday Mrs. Kretschmer goes to make her home with her daughter.

Altho the day was very unpleasant, many picnickers autoed out from Portland and ate their lunches along the river. Trolling for salmon was the attraction for some while the lure of the country brought many out from their city homes.

Miss Vera Glass and Miss Annie Russell left for Newberg on Wednesday to attend the state Sunday School convention, which meets for a three-day session.

Community Club Will Meet
The Mount Pleasant Community club has called a meeting for this evening to listen to addresses by Judge Grant B. Dimick and B. T. McBain on the \$6,000,000 bond issue. The food preparedness campaign will also be discussed by prominent speakers, led by Ward Lawton, committee-man.

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